

Neon

10
Ne

The name of this gas means the “new one”. Tiny amounts of the element are released in volcanic eruptions and end up in the air. Neon makes up around one thousandth of 1 per cent of the atmosphere.

ATOMIC MASS 20.18

STATE Gas

DISCOVERY 1898 (Sir William Ramsay and Morris Travers)



Pure neon
in a glass sphere

Argon

18
Ar

About 1 per cent of Earth's atmosphere is made up of argon, the most common noble gas on Earth.

Argon means the “lazy one” because early chemists were left with it after removing all other gases from air, and they found it did not do anything at all.

ATOMIC MASS 39.95

STATE Gas

DISCOVERY 1894 (Lord Rayleigh and Sir William Ramsay)



Small amounts of argon gas glow pale purple when electrified.

Pure argon in
a glass sphere